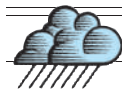


The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

RE V1 V2 V3 V4



Showers 64/42 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 53/41 **B6**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2025 • **\$4**

Backbone of climate policy could be repealed

EPA urges White House to nullify a finding on greenhouse gases' harms

BY MAXINE JOSELOW

Environmental Protection Agency Administrator Lee Zeldin has privately urged the White House to strike down a scientific finding underpinning much of the federal government's push to combat climate change, according to three people briefed on the matter who spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to comment publicly.

The 2009 "endangerment finding" cleared the way for regulating greenhouse gases under the Clean Air Act by concluding that the planet-warming gases pose a threat to public health and welfare. The Obama and Biden administrations used that determination to set strict limits on emissions from cars and power plants.

By repealing the endangerment finding, the Trump administration would be taking one of its most consequential steps yet to derail federal climate efforts. In recent days, the administration has also blocked work that is central to international climate research and barred federal scientists and diplomats from attending a major climate event in China.

On Wednesday, President Donald Trump told reporters during his first meeting with his Cabinet that Zeldin is considering cutting 65 percent of the EPA's workforce.

"I spoke with Lee Zeldin, and he thinks he's going to be cutting 65 or so percent of the people from Environmental," Trump said, adding that many EPA staffers

SEE ENVIRONMENT ON A15



JABIN BOTSFORD/THE WASHINGTON POST

President Donald Trump speaks Wednesday at the White House during the first Cabinet meeting of his second term.

Trump gives Musk his full support

BY JACQUELINE ALEMANY AND MATT VISER

President Donald Trump, amid tensions between Elon Musk and several senior officials in his administration, used the first Cabinet meeting of his second term to align himself with the billionaire who is attempting to radically downsize the federal workforce.

Trump immediately ceded the top of the meeting to Musk, who provided a summary of his efforts so far. Relegated to a far left corner of the room in a row of chairs behind the Cabinet table, Musk sported a black MAGA hat and a black T-shirt

President says Cabinet on same page as DOGE dominates first meeting

emblazoned with the phrase "Tech Support," which he said was a "literal description" of the work of the U.S. DOGE Service, which stands for Department of Government Efficiency, though it is not a Cabinet-level agency.

But Musk went on to outline how much more far-reaching the work of DOGE has been — and how necessary it is to the nation's economic health.

Trump later offered full-throated support of that mission.

"We simply cannot sustain as a country \$2 trillion deficits. Just the interest on the national debt now exceeds the Defense Department's spending," Musk said. "If this continues, the country will become de facto bankrupt."

Trump also announced that Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky would visit Friday to finalize a framework that would grant the United States partial access to Ukraine's mineral resources, and he detailed plans to start an initiative to sell "gold cards" to wealthy individuals looking for a path to U.S. citizen-

ship.

Trump spoke extensively on a wide range of foreign and domestic topics during the 65-minute meeting, where he asked several of the most senior members of his administration to expound on questions from reporters.

The president fielded several questions on the effort to end Russia's war against Ukraine. He cast the minerals deal as a

SEE CABINET ON A5

Justice nominees: Senators ask about defying court orders. **A3**

DEI orders: Art Museum of the Americas cancels two shows. **C1**

Moment of truth at hand for Kyiv

TRUMP, ZELENSKY IN HIGH-STAKES TALKS

Leaders bring different goals in Friday's U.S. trip

BY SIOBHÁN O'GRADY, DAVID L. STERN AND MISSY RYAN

KYIV — President Donald Trump and President Volodymyr Zelensky offered differing expectations Wednesday for a high-stakes summit later this week, as the Ukrainian leader underscored his need for American assurances about Kyiv's future security and the U.S. president stressed the benefits of a deal to reap Ukraine's vast mineral wealth.

Trump said he and Zelensky would use a hastily arranged meeting at the White House on Friday to finalize a mineral compact that his administration has pushed on Kyiv, as Washington tries to broker a swift end to the war with Russia on terms that could be unfavorable to Ukraine.

Trump voiced his desire to end the fighting, which three years after Russian President Vladimir Putin's full-scale invasion has killed and wounded hundreds of thousands of people on both sides.

"My number one thing is to get that stopped. My number two thing is, I don't want to have to pay any more money," Trump told reporters, referencing the billions of dollars the Biden administration

SEE UKRAINE ON A12

Starmer's visit: U.K. leader aims to be a bridge to Europe. **A8**

U.S. agencies told to submit proposals for leaving D.C.

BY AARON WIENER

The Trump administration is giving federal agencies until mid-April to suggest relocations of bureaus and offices out of the D.C. region, a move that would have widespread impacts on the local economy.

In a guidance issued Wednesday to the heads of all executive departments and agencies, the directors of the Office of Management and Budget and the Office of Personnel Management laid out steps for compliance with President Donald Trump's order to eliminate "waste, bloat and insularity" in the government. Part of that is a directive to submit "any proposed relocations of agency bureaus and offices from Washington, D.C. and the National Capital Region to less-costly parts of the country" by April 14.

The move comes amid a broader push by the administration to cut its real estate footprint and drastically reduce the size of the federal government workforce. Spurred by Elon Musk's U.S. DOGE Service, several agencies have announced plans to slash some teams by as much as 90 percent.

Also on Wednesday, Trump issued an executive order giving

SEE RELOCATIONS ON A4

Federal workers: Next DOGE cuts loom as most widespread yet. **B1**



DAN AGOSTINI FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Lincoln Gakiya, a prosecutor in São Paulo state, exits his office accompanied by his security team.

Marked to die by a formidable gang

Choice to take on Brazil's most powerful criminals carries a steep price

BY TERRENCE MCCOY

SÃO PAULO — In the back of an armored vehicle, sitting behind two men with assault rifles, Lincoln Gakiya stared out the window, restive. Standstill traffic pressed in from every direction. His security detail had already warned there was a high risk of assassination that day, and he felt fully exposed.

But Gakiya, a prosecutor in São Paulo state, believed the risk was

worth it. He had a speech planned that August morning at a local law school, and he almost never missed an opportunity to make his case to the public.

Time was running out. "Let's see if we can jump this traffic," Gakiya told his guards, and his convoy of three armored vehicles sped off, sirens blaring.

Since his death was ordered six years ago by the Primeiro Comando da Capital, considered South America's most powerful drug-

trafficking gang, Gakiya has lived behind a state security shield that rivals that of a Brazilian president: armored cars, blast-resistant doors, a rotating cast of 82 military police officers.

But his shield against the PCC will probably disappear. Brazil has no legislation that guarantees protection to law enforcement officials upon retirement — even those under threat — and Gakiya, 58, could soon be left to face some

SEE BRAZIL ON A11

Musk's empire is built upon billions in government funds

Taxpayer money arrived at critical points to help Tesla, SpaceX survive

This article is by Desmond Butler, Trisha Thadani, Emmanuel Martinez, Aaron Gregg, Luis Melgar, Jonathan O'Connell and Dan Keating

Elon Musk and his cost-cutting U.S. DOGE Service team have been on a mission to trim government largesse. Yet Musk is one of the greatest beneficiaries of the taxpayers' coffers.

Over the years, Musk and his businesses have received at least \$38 billion in government contracts, loans, subsidies and tax credits, often at critical moments, a Washington Post analysis has found, helping seed the growth

that has made him the world's richest person.

The payments stretch back more than 20 years. Shortly after becoming CEO of a cash-strapped Tesla in 2008, Musk fought hard to secure a low-interest loan from the Energy Department, according to two people directly involved with the process, holding daily briefings with company executives about the paperwork and spending hours with a government loan officer.

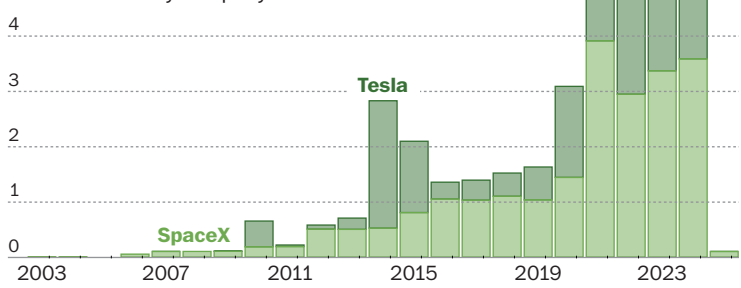
When Tesla soon after realized it was missing a crucial Environmental Protection Agency certification it needed to qualify for the loan days before Christmas, Musk went straight to the top, urging then-EPA Administrator Lisa Jackson to intervene, according to one of the people. Both people spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of retribution.

Nearly two-thirds of the

SEE MUSK ON A14

Musk's companies have received billions from the government

Total contracts, loans, subsidies and tax credits by company



Note: Business Oregon committed nearly \$6 million to a third company, X Corp.

IN THE NEWS

Gaza ceasefire Israel and Hamas appear far from agreement on moving to the truce's second phase, amid questions about disarming the militant group. **A10**

Cherry blossom forecast Peak bloom is likely to occur at the Tidal Basin between March 23 and 27, slightly earlier than normal. **B1**

THE NATION

The share of Christians in the U.S. has stabilized after years of decline, a religion poll found. **A2**
A child died of measles in Texas, the disease's first known U.S. fatality since 2015. **A3**

THE WORLD

In Syria, Israeli attacks are angering residents and unsettling the nation's new leaders. **A10**
Iran has substantially boosted production of highly enriched uranium, a watchdog said. **A11**

THE ECONOMY

A pill that could help dogs live longer has moved a step closer to FDA approval, the drug's maker said. **A13**
The Supreme Court appeared poised to lower the bar for White and heterosexual people to sue for workplace discrimination. **A15**

THE REGION

"Real Housewives" star Karen Huger was sentenced to 12 months behind bars for driving under the influence. **B1**
Prosecutors withdrew a motion to toss out the murder conviction of Adnan Syed, who was a subject of the "Serial" podcast. **B1**

STYLE

Transgender Americans, fearful during Donald Trump's presidency, are turning to guns for safety. **C1**

LOCAL LIVING

Twelve myths about laundry: Washing machines, detergents and fabrics have changed, and so have the rules.

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